



Illustration: Shyam Sriram

Your Ten-Step Guide To Home Employment

Home employment is not merely about registering on a website. It requires a lot of effort, active networking and acquiring requisite skill sets

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There is no such thing as a free lunch. Neither is there an easy way to earn money, especially from home. To make yourself employable, you need to ensure that you have the required skill sets as well as good marketing and interpersonal skills. A sound portfolio (for aspiring writers, editors, photographers, designers, et al) is a must.

Today, several private companies and MNCs are employing people who prefer working out of their homes. A host of opportunities exist for home employment in areas as diverse as telemarketing, selling insurance, data entry, accounting, writing (academic and journalistic writing), editing and proof reading, web design, content development, Internet-based research for companies, graphic design and desktop publishing, programming, audio and video editing, and translation.

With a fair bit of technology skills (typing and word processing skills, being PC literate), entrepreneurs can use the worldwide web to start companies and work from the convenience of their homes. A network security firm in Mumbai, for instance, sourced almost all its initial jobs from the Internet—crawling through Google, advertising the website, and improving its page ranking on search engines so that users looking for a certain security solution, would hit their site as soon as they entered the particular keyword.

Before you get into the home employment groove, make sure you have the requisite qualifications, hardware, and time-management skills to convince potential employers that you are the right person for the job.

The Checklist

1 STEP Make The Right Choices Before you consider quitting your day-job or begin working from home, take a piece of paper and list out your skills,

preferred areas of employment, and your comfort-level in each area. For instance, if you are a programmer, weigh the benefits of home employment versus working in a corporate environment. If you are a student, chart out your daily schedule and figure out how much time you can spare for a 'part-time' job, even if it doesn't involve stepping out of home.

Remember, you may or may not earn as much as you would in a full-time job, and freelance projects take time to source and payments are delayed, in some cases. Zeroing in on the right kind

The story titled 'Home Is Where The Money Is' featured in the February 2005 issue received nearly 700 e-mails, from readers across the country. While we cannot source jobs for our readers, we can recommend methods using which you can make yourself employable, without entering the 'corporate rat-race'.